

# Sajad Modaresi

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## Academic Appointments

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| Kenan-Flagler Business School, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill | Chapel Hill, NC |
| Assistant Professor of Operations                                          | 2018 – Present  |

## Education

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| Fuqua School of Business, Duke University                                  | Durham, NC     |
| Ph.D. in Operations Management                                             | 2018           |
| Thesis: Data-Driven Learning Models with Applications to Retail Operations |                |
| University of Pittsburgh                                                   | Pittsburgh, PA |
| M.Sc. in Industrial Engineering                                            | 2012           |
| Sharif University of Technology                                            | Tehran, Iran   |
| B.Sc. in Industrial Engineering                                            | 2010           |

## Publications

1. “A Dynamic Clustering Approach to Data-Driven Assortment Personalization”, with F. Bernstein and D. Sauré. 2019. *Management Science*, 65(5), pp. 2095–2115. **First Prize, 2018 MSOM Student Paper Competition.**
2. “Learning in Combinatorial Optimization: What and How to Explore”, with D. Sauré and J. P. Vielma. 2020. *Operations Research*, 68(5), pp. 1585–1604. **Second Prize, 2013 INFORMS JFIG Paper Competition.**
3. “Impact of Inventory Levels and Product Variety on Consumers’ Perceptions of Brands”, with K. Rajavi and S. Golara. 2024. *Production and Operations Management*, 33(9), pp. 1855–1874.
4. “Diamonds in the Rough: Leveraging Click Data to Spotlight Underrated Products”, with S.M. Emadi and V. Deshpande. 2026. *Production and Operations Management*. Forthcoming. **Finalist, 2021 MSOM Data-Driven Challenge.**
5. “A Feature-based Consideration Set Choice Model for Online Retailing”, with M.A. Farzaneh and A. Venkataraman. 2026. *M&SOM*. Forthcoming.

## Papers under Review

6. “Exploration Optimization for Dynamic Assortment Personalization under Linear Preferences”, with F. Bernstein and D. Sauré. Invited for a **minor revision** at *Operations Research*.

## Working Papers

7. “Information Traps for Consumer Learning in Assortment Planning”, with F. Del Solar and D. Sauré. *Working paper*.
8. “Bundle Price Optimization with Learning”, with T. Abdallah and A. Bennouna. *Working paper*.
9. “Bias-Variance Trade-off in Reinforcement Learning: Why Simplicity Wins”, Single Authored. *Work in progress*.
10. “Deep Reinforcement Learning in Service Systems”, with S.M. Emadi. *Work in progress*.

## Patents

- “Quick Learning Recommendation Method, Non-transitory Computer Readable Medium and System for Baskets of Goods”. *US Patent* 11,151,631, 2021.

## Teaching Experience

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Kenan-Flagler Business School, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

- BUSI 410: Business Analytics, Undergraduate Core, Fall 2018–Present
- MBA 708A: Retail Operations & Analytics, MBA Elective, Fall 2019–Present

The Fuqua School of Business, Duke University

- Decision 502: Business Mathematics Review, MBA & MMS Programs, Summer 2016

## Honors and Awards

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- Nominated for Weatherspoon Award for Excellence in Undergraduate Teaching, UNC Kenan-Flagler, 2023
- MBA Teaching All-Star Award, UNC Kenan-Flagler, 2021
- Finalist, 2021 MSOM Data-Driven Research Challenge
- First Prize, 2018 MSOM Student Paper Competition
- Second Prize, 2013 INFORMS JFIG Paper Competition
- Invited Panelist, POMS Doctoral Consortium, 2019
- The Fuqua School of Business Graduate Fellowship, 2013
- University of Pittsburgh Graduate Fellowship, 2010
- University Honor for Exceptionally Outstanding Undergraduate Student, Sharif University, 2010
- Ranked 3<sup>rd</sup> in B.Sc. class (Industrial Engineering), Sharif University, 2010
- Ranked Top 0.1% in Iran's National University Entrance Exam (400,000+ participants), 2006

## Student Advising

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- Amin Farzaneh (PhD committee member, co-author), University of Texas at Dallas, 2026 (expected)
- Felipe del Solar (Master's thesis committee member), University of Chile, 2025
- Dishita Sen (Honors thesis committee member), UNC Chapel Hill, 2024
- Dayton Steele (PhD committee member), UNC Chapel Hill, 2022

## Professional Service

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To the Discipline

- Reviewer Service: *Management Science, Operations Research, Manufacturing and Service Operations Management, Production and Operations Management, Service Science*
- Judge: MSOM Supply Chain SIG (2020, 2021, 2022, 2025), JFIG Competition (2019), DSI Buffa Dissertation Award (2019), Research Grants Council of Hong Kong (2018–2019)
- Session Chair: INFORMS (2019, 2025), POMS (2019, 2020, 2021)

At UNC Chapel Hill

- Co-Organizer, Operations Area Seminar Series, 2019–2025
- Member, Faculty Need Trends Discovery Working Group, 2020

## Invited Talks

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- Fidelity AI center, April 2025.
- Kellogg School of Management, Northwestern University, April 2024.
- Statistics & Operations Research Department, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill, March 2024.
- Carey Business School, Johns Hopkins University, May 2023.
- Oracle Corporation, February 2022.
- “The Job Market Experience: Candid Conversations”, Invited Panelist at the POMS Doctoral Consortium, May 2019.
- McCombs School of Business, University of Texas at Austin, 2018.
- Kelley School of Business, Indiana University, 2018.
- Imperial College Business School, 2018.

- McGill University, Desautels Faculty of Management, 2018.
- University of California, Riverside, School of Business Administration, 2018.
- Lindner College of Business, University of Cincinnati, 2018.
- University of Illinois at Chicago, College of Business Administration, 2018.
- University of Nebraska-Lincoln, College of Business, 2018.
- Kenan-Flagler Business School, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill, 2017.
- Fox School of Business, Temple University, 2017.
- Lundquist College of Business, University of Oregon, 2017.

## Conference Presentations

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- INFORMS Annual Meeting, Atlanta, GA, 2025 (scheduled).
- INFORMS RMP Section Conference, NYC, NY, 2024.
- INFORMS RMP Section Conference, Los Angeles, CA, 2024.
- MSOM Annual Conference, Minneapolis, MN, 2024.
- MSOM Annual Conference, Montreal, QC, 2023.
- INFORMS Annual Meeting, Indianapolis, IN, 2022.
- POMS Annual Conference, 2022 (online).
- INFORMS Annual Meeting, 2021 (online).
- MSOM Annual Conference, 2021 (online).
- POMS Annual Conference, 2021 (online).
- INFORMS Annual Meeting, Seattle, WA, 2019.
- POMS Annual Conference, Washington, DC, 2019.
- INFORMS Annual Meeting, Phoenix, AZ, 2018.
- MSOM Student Paper Competition, INFORMS Annual Meeting, Phoenix, AZ, 2018.
- INFORMS Annual Meeting, Houston, TX, 2017.
- MSOM Annual Conference, Chapel Hill, NC, 2017.
- POMS Annual Conference, Seattle, WA, 2017.
- INFORMS Annual Meeting, Nashville, TN, 2016.
- Amazon's Supply Chain Optimization Summit, Seattle, WA, 2016 (Poster presentation).
- INFORMS Revenue Management and Pricing Section Conference, NY, 2016.
- POMS Annual Conference, Orlando, FL, 2016.
- INFORMS Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, PA, 2015.
- INFORMS Annual Meeting, San Francisco, CA, 2014.
- INFORMS Annual Meeting, Phoenix, AZ, 2012.